

browsers will reach 1.4 billion at the end of 2013. Although the installed base of this size represents a very potent market for mobile application developers, in practice the vast majority of them continue to choose the native model over the Web for their releases.

"Two years ago it still looked like 2013 could be the 'Year of Web App' but now looks like that this will prove more like a 'year of hybrid.' HTML5 is making strides, but mainly through developers that take advantage of increasingly capable cross-platform development tools. Meanwhile, there aren't many signs of full-blown Web apps effectively challenging the native way," said Aapo Markkanen, senior analyst, ABI Research.

Govt receives Rs 20,000 million investment proposals for electronics

It seems Indian electronics industry is getting really lucrative for investors these days. The Indian government has received investment proposals of over Rs 20,000 million for setting up electronics manufacturing clusters. These clusters have been proposed to be set up in south India.

According to a PTI report, the information about the investment proposals was revealed by Dr Ajay Kumar, joint secretary, Department of Electronics and Information Technology. "There have been fresh investment proposals for three greenfield electronics manufacturing clusters (EMCs) of over Rs 20,000 million. They will be scrutinised before final approval," said Kumar while speaking to PTI.

IESA to devise ESDM roadmap for Odisha

The government is fast realising the scope of electronics in India. As per the estimates, it is being said that the demand for electronics in India was \$45 billion in 2008-09 and this figure is expected to touch \$400 billion by 2020. The latest development is that the Odisha IT department has entrusted India Electronics and Semiconductor



Indian electronics industry is getting lucrative for investors

Association (IESA) to prepare a roadmap for the development of electronic system design and manufacturing (ESDM) industry in the state within six months, and it was expected to start work from April.

PMA policy to push manufacturing of only a few components in India

The government recently issued the Preferential Market Access (PMA) guidelines for desktop PCs, laptops, tablets, dot-matrix printers and smart cards, with an objective to give a fillip to the domestic manufacturing industry, and to put an end to India's dependence on imports. However, the guidelines for all these products do not mandate that the components going into making these products have to be manufactured domestically. Therefore the PMA policy will drive the growth of indigenous manufacturing only to a certain extent.

First phase of e-MSIPS launched

The Union Communications and IT minister, Kapil Sibal, has launched the first phase of Electronic Systems Design and Manufacturing portal, e-MSIPS.

e-MSIPS is a Web-based system, which supports processes for online submission of applications under Modified Special Incentive Package Scheme (M-SIPS). The e-MSIPS replaces the existing manual system of submission of M-SIPS applications in hard copies to Nodal Officer, which are processed in DeitY and presented to Appraisal Committee for approval of incentives.

Solar power projects stalled due to lack of government clarity

The Andhra Pradesh government had announced its new Solar Power policy on 26th September last year, which outlined the government's desire to push for more renewable energy to be made available in the country. Following the announcement of the scheme, applications to supply solar generators that would create over 750 MW of clean energy were submitted to the government, with more in the pipeline. As of now, not a single one of these submissions has been approved. Federation of Andhra Pradesh Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FAPCCI) maintains that the reason for this stall in proceedings is because the policy did not envisage any investment subsidy from the government or the power utilities.

Imports of electronic goods up by 30 per cent in 2012

The increasing import of electronic goods is a major concern for the Indian government. According to the minister of state for Communications and IT, Milind Deora, India's imports of electronic goods like mobiles and cameras rose almost 30 per cent to Rs 1570 billion in 2011-12.

The country had imported electronic products worth Rs 1210 billion in 2010-11.

DeitY discusses roadmap for implementation of PMA policy

In an attempt to clarify the implementation of policy for preference to